

» CONIFERS

male cone
withers after
shedding pollen



DEODAR
Cedrus deodara
F: Pinaceae

Native to the W. Himalayas, this fast-growing cedar has branches that droop at their tips. Its cones are purple-brown when ripe.

immature cone

50 m/165 ft



60 m/200 ft

DOUGLAS FIR
Pseudotsuga menziesii
F: Pinaceae
One of the world's tallest conifers, the Douglas fir grows in western N. America. Its cones have projecting bracts formed from modified scales.

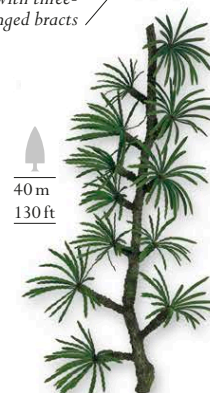
mature cone
with three-
pronged bracts



60 m
200 ft

WESTERN HEMLOCK
Tsuga heterophylla
F: Pinaceae

From western N. America, this is the largest hemlock. It thrives in cool, damp conditions, and can live to be over 1,000 years old.



40 m
130 ft

GOLDEN LARCH
Pseudolarix amabilis
F: Pinaceae

Native to E. China, the golden larch turns brilliant yellow in autumn before losing its leaves. Its cones break up as they scatter their seeds.



40 m
130 ft

ATLAS CEDAR
Cedrus atlantica
F: Pinaceae

This N. African cedar has short needles and upright barrel-shaped cones. When ripe, the cones slowly break up to release their seeds.

40 m/130 ft



CEDAR OF LEBANON
Cedrus libani
F: Pinaceae

A majestic conifer with spreading branches, the cedar of Lebanon is now rare in the wild, but is widely planted as an ornamental tree.



30 m/98 ft

JAPANESE LARCH
Larix kaempferi
F: Pinaceae

A deciduous tree – like all larches – this has soft leaves and persistent woody cones with downcurved scales. It grows on mountains in N. Japan.



50 m/165 ft

MONKEY PUZZLE
Araucaria araucana
F: Araucariaceae

Originally from the mountains of Chile, this primeval-looking tree has spirally arranged, sharply pointed leaves. Mature trees develop an umbrella-like crown.



25 m/82 ft

JAPANESE UMBRELLA PINE
Sciadopitys verticillata
F: Sciadopityaceae

The only member of its family, this ancient Japanese species is distinguished from other conifers by having 10–13 needles clustered in whorls.